
Paper 2, Option 2D.1: The unification of Italy, c1830–70

Overview

This option comprises a study in depth of the Italian states from the 1830 revolutions, through the growing economic and political dominance of Piedmont, to the creation and consolidation of the Kingdom of Italy in the years 1861–70.

Students will gain an in-depth understanding of the nature and extent of change within the Italian states, and the extent to which unity within Italy was established by its leaders rather than by the growth of Italian nationalism.

Key topics	Content
1 Challenges to the restored order and the failure of revolution, c1830–49	- Challenges to the restored order, 1830–1847: political geography in 1830; the failure of the 1830–32 revolutions; the cultural challenge of the <i>Risorgimento</i>; political ideas and secret societies; economic divisions and social problems. - Nationalist influences, 1830–47; Mazzini and Young Italy; Balbo and the rule of Charles Albert in Piedmont; Gioberti and the reforms of Pope Pius IX. - Revolutions of 1848–49: short-term causes; outbreak of revolution in the Italian states; counter-revolutions; the Roman Republic, 1848–49. The situation in Piedmont, including the First Italian War of Independence. - Reasons for failure of revolutions: Austrian and French intervention; reaction of the papacy; Piedmont's weaknesses; lack of revolutionary unity and popular support; lack of international support.
2 The rise of Piedmont, 1849–56	- Legacy of the 1848–49 revolutions: Victor Emmanuel II and the <i>Statuto</i>; the impact on Austrian dominance; the impact on the papacy; the French occupation of Rome; the failure of Mazzini; developments in liberalism and nationalism. - Political developments in Piedmont: the rule of Victor Emmanuel II; the appointment of Cavour 1852 and its impact; anticlericalism; policies to create political stability; liberal and nationalist influences. - Economic developments in Piedmont: commercial and industrial growth; the significance of trade agreements and the impact of the development of railways; government investment in infrastructure; the significance of Cavour.

Key topics	Content
3 The creation of the Kingdom of Italy, 1856–61	• Causes of the Second Italian War of Independence, and its outbreak: support from Piedmont for nationalists; relations with Napoleon III; significance of the Orsini Affair and Pact of Plombières; the preparation for and outbreak of war with Austria. • Impact of war with Austria, 1859–60: significance of Magenta and Solferino; the nature of the peace settlement. Cavour's resignation and its significance; annexation of central Italian states; loss of Nice and Savoy. • Garibaldi's takeover of the south in 1860: Garibaldi's aims and objectives; Garibaldi's relationship with Cavour and Victor Emmanuel II; expedition to and success in Sicily; invasion and takeover of Naples. • The north and south unite, 1860–61: Garibaldi's decision to take Rome and the response of Piedmont; the significance of the meeting at Teano; plebiscites in the south and papal territories. The Kingdom of Italy established.
4 Consolidating the Kingdom of Italy, 1861–70	• Obstacles to unity after 1861: Austrian and French influence; the papacy; the reaction to 'Piedmontisation', including the 'Brigands' war', 1861–65; the economic and social impact of the north-south divide. • Solving the 'Venetian question', 1861–66: failure of Garibaldi, 1862–64; aims of Victor Emmanuel; diplomacy with Prussia and war with Austria 1866; union with Venetia. • Solving the problem of Rome, 1861–70: the papacy and French occupation; the failure of Garibaldi and diplomacy, 1862–67; the impact of the Franco-Prussian war; the Italian takeover of Rome. • Unity in 1870: factors promoting unity, including the constitutional monarchy and national institutions; the divisive effects of social and economic problems, papal opposition, political disunity and continued <i>irredenta</i>.